

Appreciation Letter

I am Syed Naqi Abbas, a B.Tech student in Information Technology at Kamla Nehru Institute of Technology (KNIT), Sultanpur, India. I had the great privilege of working as a Research Intern at the National Astronomical Observatory of Japan (NAOJ) from December 2024 to July 2025, under the supervision of Dr. Maria Giovanna Dainotti. This experience has been one of the most formative and rewarding chapters of my academic journey, and I am deeply grateful for the opportunity.

Under Dr. Dainotti's guidance, I worked on the reconstruction of Gamma-Ray Burst (GRB) light curves using advanced machine and deep learning techniques. The research environment she fostered was exceptional as intellectually stimulating, collaborative, and always driven by a pursuit of scientific rigour. Dr. Dainotti's mentorship style encouraged independent thinking while ensuring that the highest standards of research quality were maintained at every step.

During the internship, I contributed to two peer-reviewed publications. The first, "Gamma-Ray Burst Light Curve Reconstruction: A Comparative Machine and Deep Learning Analysis," and was submitted to The Astrophysical Journal Supplement Series (ApJS). The second, "A Multi-Model Framework for Reconstructing GRB Light Curves," was published in New Astronomy (2025). Having my work culminate in published research at this stage of my career is something I owe in large part to Dr. Dainotti's mentorship and the collaborative spirit of the team at NAOJ.

Beyond the research itself, Dr. Dainotti's dedication to her students and collaborators is truly inspiring. She creates an environment where young researchers feel genuinely valued, supported, and challenged to grow. I am a better researcher and a more disciplined thinker because of my time working under her supervision.

I wholeheartedly recommend Dr. Maria Giovanna Dainotti as a mentor and research supervisor. Any student fortunate enough to work under her guidance will find themselves in an environment that brings out their very best. I am deeply thankful for everything this experience has given me and look forward to continuing to build on the foundation she helped me lay.

Cheers,

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